

Build-Credit-From-Zero 12-Month Plan

Financially Sovereign Academy · Module 4: Credit Scores Decoded · Worksheet v0.1 · 2026-07-04

What this is. Credit is built slowly through small, steady habits, not tricks. This one page helps you set up a simple 12-month plan and track it by hand. Fill it in yourself. Example amounts are examples only; use your own numbers.

1. My starting point

From Module 4: you cannot improve what you have not looked at.

- Do I have a credit file yet? ☐ Yes ☐ Not sure ☐ No
- My starting score, if I have one: _____ (or “none yet”)
- Where I checked it: _____

2. On-time payment tracker

On-time payments are the biggest single habit. Mark each month you paid on time.

Month	Paid on time?	Month	Paid on time?
1	☐	7	☐
2	☐	8	☐
3	☐	9	☐
4	☐	10	☐
5	☐	11	☐
6	☐	12	☐

3. Credit-utilization target

Utilization is how much of your limit you use. Lower is usually better.

- My credit limit: \$ _____
- Amount I aim to keep the balance under: \$ _____
- My target: use no more than about 30 percent, less is better
- One way I will keep the balance low: _____

4. Dispute-an-error checklist

Errors are common. From Module 4, you have the right to dispute them.

- ☐ Pull my report from each major bureau
- ☐ Circle anything I do not recognize
- ☐ Gather any proof I have
- ☐ File the dispute in writing and keep a copy
- ☐ Note the date I filed: _____
- ☐ Follow up if I hear nothing back

5. Myth vs fact

Cross out the myth once you have read the fact.

Myth	Fact
Carrying a balance builds credit	Paying in full and on time is what helps
Checking my own score hurts it	Checking your own score does not lower it

Myth	Fact
Closing old cards helps my score	Closing them can shorten history and raise utilization

6. Pressure and trap reminder

Fast “credit repair” offers that charge big fees or promise a guaranteed number are a warning sign. You can do most of this yourself for free.

- One myth I used to believe: _____
- One thing I will stop doing: _____

7. My next 7-day action

One small thing I will do in the next 7 days: _____

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